BUYER'S GUIDE · FLORIDA

THE 16 QUESTIONS TO ASK BEFORE BUYING PROPERTY IN FLORIDA

Most buyers only ask how much the property costs.

Experienced investors look beyond obvious.



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A better decision starts with a better question.

Most buyers arrive at the negotiation table with a single question in mind: how much does the property cost.

Experienced investors ask something else. They ask the questions that reveal the true cost of ownership, how the area is expected to develop over the coming years, and how liquid the asset will be at resale.

Before signing anything, work through the questions that follow. Each answer changes the real value of the deal.



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SECTION I · 01 — 12

Buying in general and pre-construction

01 Is the developer reliable?

FOR NEW CONSTRUCTION

- What is the developer's track record?
- Do they consistently deliver on schedule?
- What do previous buyers say about them?
- Is there a warranty after delivery?

02 What is the appreciation potential of the area?

- Is the neighborhood growing?
- Are new developments, offices, schools or infrastructure planned?
- Is land scarce, or is a large supply coming to market?

03 What are the rental rules?

- Does the association allow short-term rentals (Airbnb)?
- Is there an in-house rental program?
- What will the management company charge?
- What does that management include? If there is a leak or an A/C failure, who handles it?
- Can I manage the rental myself?
- Are there limits on rentals per year or a minimum stay requirement?

04 What does it cost to own this property?

- What is the HOA fee?
- What is included in that fee?
- Are there special assessments approved or expected?
- What are property taxes, insurance and other recurring expenses?

05 What are the financing terms?

- Does the developer offer incentives?
- Are there promotional interest rates?
- How much is the down payment?
- Can foreign nationals obtain financing?

06 How much will it cost to close?

- What are the closing costs?
- Who pays for each expense?
- Are there credits or incentives offered by the developer?

07 Does the investment actually make sense?

- What is the expected appreciation?
- What is the estimated rental income?
- What is the average occupancy rate in the area?
- Does the cash flow cover every expense?

08 Is this the best unit?

- Does this floor plan tend to hold value better?
- Does the view add value?
- What is the sun exposure?
- Does the floor level affect the resale price?



09 How healthy are the association's finances?

- Are there financial reserves?
- Is a fee increase expected?
- Is building maintenance up to date?

10 Will this property be easy to sell later?

- Who is the buyer five or ten years from now?
- Is there demand for this type of property?
- How liquid is the asset?

11 Can I assign my contract before delivery?

PRE-CONSTRUCTION

- Does the developer allow contract assignment?
- Are there fees for it?
- Are there restrictions on reselling before delivery?

12 Are there specific rules for international buyers?

- Are there financing limitations?
- Are there specific requirements for foreign investors?
- Are there restrictions on renting or reselling?



SECTION II · 13 — 14

If the property is a resale

13 How much will the renovation cost?

- Does the property need a refresh or a full renovation?
- How much will that renovation cost, and how long should it take?
- Will flooring, kitchen or bathrooms need to be replaced?
- Is the roof in good condition?
- Are the electrical and plumbing systems up to date?
- Is the A/C new?
- Are the windows hurricane rated (impact windows)?
- Are there signs of water intrusion or structural issues?
- Does the HOA require approval for renovations?

IMPORTANT

What should the property be worth once the renovation is complete?

14 How much will maintenance cost over the next few years?

- How old is the roof?
- Is the A/C near the end of its service life?
- Will the water heater need replacing?
- Will the appliances need replacing?
- Is the association planning any major expense?

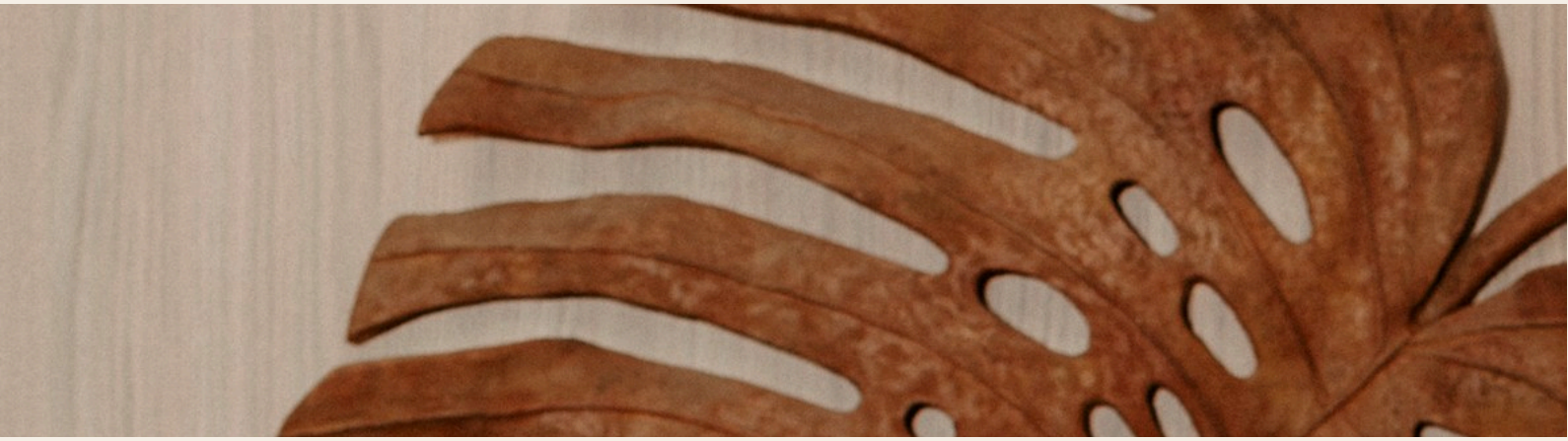
SECTION III · 15

Insurance in Florida

15 How much will insurance cost?

In Florida, insurance can vary considerably. Ask:

- What is the estimated homeowner's insurance premium?
- Does the property have features that lower it, such as impact windows or roof straps?
- For condominiums, does the association cover part of the policy?



SECTION IV · 16

Orlando and short-term rental

16 How much will it cost to make the property income-ready?

One of the expenses investors most often leave out. Ask:

- Is the property already furnished?
- How much will furnishing it cost?
- Will themed decor be required (Disney, Harry Potter, Marvel, princesses)?
- Does that type of decor make sense for the area's target guest?
- How much will linens, kitchenware and appliances cost?
- Who will handle the interior design?
- How long until the property is ready to receive guests?



The right question changes the decision.

This guide exists so you reach the negotiation knowing exactly what to ask — and so you can read each answer for what it really means.

If you'd like to review these answers case by case, applied to the property and the area you're considering, let's talk.

LET'S TALK ABOUT YOUR FLORIDA PLAN →



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